



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Eggs

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated vs stored in water glass

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Eggs

FRESH

up to 6 days at room temperature but usually refrigerated; commercially washed eggs should be refrigerated and discarded if kept too long

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated vs stored in water glass)

stored in water glass (lime water) can last weeks longer, but quality may decline

WOW

Unwashed eggs can be kept safely at room temperature for about 6 days, but commercially washed eggs must be refrigerated and discarded after a shorter time.

Safety: Discard cooked or hard-cooked eggs, egg dishes, and eggs stored improperly; commercial eggs are usually washed and need refrigeration.

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Butternut Winter Squash

Preserved by: fresh stored at 50-55°F vs frozen

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Butternut Winter Squash

FRESH

2-3 months stored carefully at 50-55°F and 50-70% humidity

PRESERVED (fresh stored at 50-55°F vs frozen)

frozen for 10-12 months maintaining quality

WOW

Hard-shelled winter squashes like butternut can last 2-3 months fresh if stored properly at 50-55°F, much longer than many realize.

Safety: Keep surface dry to prevent decay fungi and do not store near ethylene-producing fruits like apples to avoid early yellowing and spoilage.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Green Beans

*Preserved by: fresh refrigerated vs pickled
(boiling water canned)*

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Green Beans

FRESH

3-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated vs pickled (boiling water canned))

at least 1 year shelf stable if processed by boiling water bath canner

WOW

Properly pickled and canned green beans can last a year or more, vastly outlasting the few days fresh green beans last refrigerated.

Safety: Follow exact acid and processing times as insufficient heat or acidity can allow dangerous bacteria growth.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Seafood (Salmon and Crab)

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated vs frozen

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Seafood (Salmon and Crab)

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated vs frozen)

up to 3 months frozen at 0°F for quality

WOW

Even though seafood is highly perishable fresh, freezing at 0°F can safely preserve it for up to 3 months while maintaining acceptable quality.

Safety: Freeze seafood quickly and keep at a consistent 0°F; thaw in refrigerator or cold water, cooking immediately afterward.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Lemon Curd

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated vs home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Lemon Curd

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated after preparation

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated vs home canned (water bath))

3-4 months shelf stable stored cool, dark place home canned

WOW

Home canned lemon curd can last 3-4 months on the shelf, much longer than the 1-2 weeks fresh curd lasts in the fridge.

Safety: Discard lemon curd showing browning or separation; use approved canning processing times based on altitude.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Cherries

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Cherries

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

up to 12 months, home canned

WOW

While fresh cherries last less than a week refrigerated, canned cherries can last up to a year safely in the pantry.

Safety: Always check home-canned jars for spoilage signs before use; discard if lids are unsealed or liquid is cloudy.

Source: PNW 736 Fruit pie filling home canning



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Strawberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-07

Strawberry Jam

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Strawberries spoil in just a day or two fresh, but jam canned at home can keep its quality for over a year.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place to maintain quality; discard if lids don't seal or show spoilage.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Home Canned Apples

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Home Canned Apples

FRESH

1-3 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Fresh apples can last weeks in the fridge, but canned apples remain safe and good for over a year without refrigeration.

Safety: Use proper home canning methods and store in a cool, dark place; discard any jars showing spoilage.

Source: SP 50-446 Preserving apples



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Canned Peaches

Preserved by: home canned (boiling water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Canned Peaches

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (boiling water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Peaches go bad in about a week fresh but can keep for over a year when canned properly.

Safety: Always use a tested home canning recipe; discard any jars with unsealed lids or signs of spoilage.

Source: SP 50-444 Preserving peaches



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Kiwi

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-10

Fresh Kiwi

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated)

10-12 months, home canned jam

WOW

Fresh kiwi can stay good up to two weeks when refrigerated, but canned kiwi jam also lasts nearly a year sealed.

Safety: Store jam jars in a cool, dark place; consume within recommended time for best quality and safety.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Tomatoes

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Tomatoes

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated)

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Fresh tomatoes last only a couple weeks in the fridge but home canned tomatoes can stay safely edible for over a year.

Safety: Store home canned tomatoes in a cool, dark place and check seals to ensure safety; discard any jars with signs of spoilage.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Salsa

Preserved by: fresh refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Salsa

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh refrigerated)

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Fresh salsa spoils very quickly in the fridge, but when canned properly, salsa can last safely for over a year.

Safety: Use only tested salsa recipes with proper acidification; improper processing can cause spoilage or botulism risk.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Tomato Paste Salsa

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Tomato Paste Salsa

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months canned

WOW

Even spicy tomato paste salsas, which seem dense and robust, last only days fresh but up to 18 months canned.

Safety: Always use bottled lemon or lime juice and proper acidification for safe home canning.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Green Salsa (Tomatillo Salsa)

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-14

Fresh Green Salsa (Tomatillo Salsa)

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12 months canned

WOW

Green salsas made from tomatillos spoil fast fresh but can keep up to a full year when canned properly with acid.

Safety: Boiling water processing and acid (bottled lemon juice) needed to prevent spoilage and ensure safety.

Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Ripe Tomatoes (unrefrigerated)

Preserved by: fresh unrefrigerated

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



HL-15

Fresh Ripe Tomatoes (unrefrigerated)

FRESH

3-7 days unrefrigerated

PRESERVED (fresh unrefrigerated)

12-18 months canned

WOW

Ripe fresh tomatoes left unrefrigerated only last around a week, but canned tomatoes last well beyond a year safely.

Safety: Do not use overripe or frost-damaged tomatoes for canning; product quality and safety may be compromised.

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Mushrooms

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Mushrooms

FRESH

3-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Fresh mushrooms last only about a week refrigerated, but pressure canned mushrooms can stay good safely for over a year.

Safety: Mushrooms must be canned using a pressure canner due to low acidity to prevent botulism.

Source: SP 50-919 Preserving mushrooms



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Potatoes

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Potatoes

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated or stored in cool dark

PRESERVED (frozen)

10-12 months frozen

WOW

Frozen potatoes maintain good quality for nearly a year, far longer than fresh refrigerated potatoes last.

Safety: Freeze at 0°F or below and do not refreeze if thawed above 40°F.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Cooked Meat

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner)

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Cooked Meat

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner))

1-2 years, home canned

WOW

Properly pressure canned cooked meat can last up to two years safely, while fresh cooked meat spoils in under a week.

Safety: Fresh cooked meat is highly perishable; pressure canning is critical to prevent botulism in preserved low acid meat.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Carrots

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Carrots

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)

10-12 months frozen

WOW

Frozen carrots maintain quality about a year, far longer than their short refrigerated life.

Safety: Freeze promptly and keep at 0°F for safety and quality; do not refreeze after thawing above 40°F.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Summer Squash

Preserved by: home canned (pressure canner) or frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Summer Squash

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (pressure canner) or frozen)

12-18 months frozen, 12-18 months pressure canned

WOW

Fresh summer squash spoils in days, but correctly pressure canned or frozen squash keeps for over a year.

Safety: Use pressure canning only; boiling water canners do not safely process low acid squash.

Source: SP 50-447 Preserving summer squash



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Bread and Butter Pickles

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Bread and Butter Pickles

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

up to 1 year, best quality 4 to 5 weeks after processing

WOW

After processing, pickles develop the best flavor only after 4 to 5 weeks but remain safe for up to a year.

Safety: Store jars in a cool, dark, dry place; do not consume if jars unseal during storage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Summer Squash Relish

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Summer Squash Relish

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

up to 1 year home canned

WOW

Fresh summer squash lasts only a few days, but pickled squash relish can be shelf-stable for up to a year.

Safety: Use proper canning times and store in a cool, dark place; discard if jars do not seal properly.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pickled Dill Beans

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pickled Dill Beans

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

up to 1 year home canned

WOW

Fresh green beans spoil quickly, but pickling them with vinegar extends shelf life to a year or more.

Safety: Process jars properly in boiling water canner; store in cool dark place to maintain safety and quality.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Sweet Gherkin Pickles

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Sweet Gherkin Pickles

FRESH

about 1 week refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

up to 1 year home canned

WOW

Fresh gherkins only last about a week when refrigerated, but pickled versions last safe for a year.

Safety: Store processed jars in cool, dark place; use within one year for best quality.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pickled Summer Squash

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pickled Summer Squash

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

up to 1 year home canned

WOW

Fresh summer squash spoils quickly but pickled squash stored properly may last up to a year safely.

Safety: Ensure jars seal properly and store in cool, dark place to prevent spoilage.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Elderberry Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Elderberry Jam

FRESH

3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Elderberry jam must have high sugar content to safely prevent botulism when home canned due to its low acidity.

Safety: Use exact sugar ratios as per recipe to ensure safety; do not substitute sweeteners.

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Concord Grape Jam

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Concord Grape Jam

FRESH

5-7 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Processed Concord grape jam can safely last over a year at room temperature unlike its fresh grape counterpart.

Safety: Use proper water bath times and jar seals to ensure safe shelf life.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Low Sugar Fruit Spread

Preserved by: refrigerated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Low Sugar Fruit Spread

FRESH

3-4 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (refrigerated)

Not shelf stable, refrigerated only

WOW

Low sugar fruit spreads cannot be canned safely and must be refrigerated and used quickly.

Safety: Do not can low sugar spreads; store only refrigerated and use within a month.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Uncooked Freezer Jam

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Uncooked Freezer Jam

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)

8-12 months frozen

WOW

Uncooked freezer jams last much longer frozen (up to a year) than refrigerated (just days).

Safety: Keep frozen at 0°F or below; safe beyond best quality period but texture may change.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Orange Marmalade

Preserved by: home canned (water bath)

Guess: how long does it last

FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Orange Marmalade

FRESH

7-10 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (home canned (water bath))

12-18 months, home canned

WOW

Orange marmalade safely keeps for over a year canned, but fresh lasts just over a week refrigerated.

Safety: Proper boiling water bath and sealing is essential for safety and shelf life.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Fresh Apples

Preserved by: refrigerated cold storage

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Fresh Apples

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (refrigerated cold storage)

3-6 months refrigerated (32-40°F, 90-95% humidity)

WOW

Fresh apples last only a couple of weeks refrigerated, but properly cold stored apples can keep quality for up to half a year!

Safety: Keep apples in plastic bags or in a refrigerator vegetable drawer to maintain moisture and prevent spoilage.

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Carrots

Preserved by: refrigerated cold storage

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Carrots

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (refrigerated cold storage)

8-12 months frozen

WOW

Frozen carrots can last nearly a year at 0°F while fresh carrots only last a couple of weeks in the fridge!

Safety: Store frozen carrots at 0°F or below to maintain quality and safety.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Green Peas

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Green Peas

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)



8-12 months frozen

WOW

Frozen green peas keep peak quality for up to a year while fresh peas spoil within days!

Safety: Store frozen peas at 0°F or lower; refreeze only if still contains ice crystals.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Lamb Roasts/Steaks

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Lamb Roasts/Steaks

FRESH



3-5 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (frozen)



9 months frozen

WOW

Lamb roasts or steaks can last over 8 months frozen but only a few days fresh before spoiling.

Safety: Freeze quickly in packages no larger than 1-2 pounds for optimal freezing and storage quality.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Pumpkin / Winter Squash

Preserved by: frozen

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Pumpkin / Winter Squash

FRESH

2-6 months in cool storage at 50-55°F

PRESERVED (frozen)

8-12 months frozen at 0°F or below

WOW

Some winter squash varieties last several months fresh in cool storage, but freezing them can preserve quality for even longer, up to a year.

Safety: Store squash at 50-55°F with 50-70% relative humidity; freezing preserves quality but not texture and requires blanching before freezing.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Dried Apples

Preserved by: dehydrated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Dried Apples

FRESH

1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (dehydrated)

6-12 months, dried

WOW

Dried apples can last up to a year, far outlasting fresh apples kept refrigerated for just a couple of weeks.

Safety: Store dried fruits in airtight containers in a cool, dark place to maintain quality.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Home Smoked Fish

Preserved by: hot smoked

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Home Smoked Fish

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated

PRESERVED (hot smoked)

1-2 weeks refrigerated

WOW

Hot smoking extends refrigerated fish shelf life from just a couple of days to up to two weeks, but only with proper cooking and temperature control.

Safety: Smoked fish must be cooked to at least 150°F internal temperature and stored cold; smoke alone is not a preservative.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Jerky

Preserved by: dried and cured

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Jerky

FRESH

1-2 days refrigerated raw meat

PRESERVED (dried and cured)

1-2 months room temperature, 3-6 months refrigerated, up to 1 year frozen

WOW

Jerky can last several months unrefrigerated, a massive increase compared to raw meat's couple of days.

Safety: Store jerky in a cool, dark, dry place; check periodically for mold and discard if any is found.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Dried Carrot

Preserved by: dehydrated

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Dried Carrot

FRESH



1-2 weeks refrigerated

PRESERVED (dehydrated)



10-12 months dried

WOW

Dried carrots last nearly a year, a stark improvement over fresh carrots' two weeks.

Safety: Store dried carrots in a sealed container away from light and moisture to maintain quality.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



HOW LONG DOES IT LAST?

Home Cured Bacon

Preserved by: smoked and cured

Guess: how long does it last
FRESH vs. PRESERVED?

Flip for the answer.



Home Cured Bacon

FRESH

1 week refrigerated fresh pork belly

PRESERVED (smoked and cured)

2 weeks refrigerated smoked bacon, months frozen

WOW

Smoking and curing bacon extends refrigerated storage from about a week fresh to two weeks and even longer if frozen.

Safety: Cook bacon thoroughly and refrigerate; smoke alone does not ensure safety without temperature control.

Source: PNW 784 Making bacon at home